

## Sober, But A Worm

A new version of the Sober worm is spreading rapidly. Called Sober-M or Sober-N, it uses an e-mail to convince recipients that their e-mail is being diverted to the alleged sender. The subject is "I've got your e-mail on my\_account!" The infected .zip file is commonly named "your\_text.zip".



## Linux: Automated Again

Linus Torvalds has launched a new tool—Git, to manage his software project. Torvalds stopped using a management system called BitKeeper, reverting to an older, slower technique of simply e-mailing updates among the hundreds of programmers who contribute to the project.



# Enter

**Kailash Kher**  
Singer

An ardent follower of Ustad Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, Kailash Kher created a stir with his debut number 'Allah Ke Bande'. His rugged voice and passionate lyrics let him connect equally well with the masses and the classes. We asked him about his thoughts on technology and on how it touches his life. Excerpts.

**What does technology mean to you?**

Technology is a very important part of life. In this tech-savvy world, being oblivious to technology is like committing suicide.

**What role does technology play in your daily life?**

I have to use technology in some form or the other daily. My recording studio is rigged up with the latest systems that help me deliver a better song each time I record. Even rehearsals are impossible without gadgets! So they're important—but I may not be able to tell you how it works because I have people who help me understand it.

**How often do you use the Internet?**

I do not surf regularly; my team members check and respond to my mails. Every once in a while when I find time, I log on.

**What kind of gadgets do you own?**

I own a cell phone. I try and make my music as digital as possible. The sounds of *dhols* and *chambals* are all digitally modified to suit my songs.

**Does technology have any influence on your music?**

It does... I listen to a lot of variations before finalising what will fit into my style.

"BUSINESS AS USUAL"

## Adobe Dreamweaver?

It's the merger of the millennium—Adobe has entered an agreement to acquire chief rival Macromedia for about \$3.4 billion in stock. The companies intend to combine their software into 'integrated solutions' and might tap unexplored markets such as the mobile and enterprise segments.

while Macromedia CEO Steven Elop becomes Adobe's president of worldwide field operations.

Analysts around the world and those who have been following the fortunes of Adobe over the years feel this decision has been driven by the fear of a competitor that doesn't exist. This, in fact, has also

beginning to dominate mobile multimedia as well; Flash is expected to ship with 75 per cent of mobile phones within five years.

The growing reach of PDF and Flash has sparked concern at Microsoft, which in turn began to develop its own offerings. Office 2003 shipped with InfoPath for creating forms and sharing information, and Longhorn is expected to ship with further document-sharing alternatives to PDF.

Across cyberspace, though, the reaction has been mixed and while some laud the move, others are not sure what this will mean. Forums across the Internet have been rife with speculation whether Adobe will discontinue any Macromedia products and which one it will merge with its existing products. Flash and Dreamweaver, it is believed, will be the two major ones to survive on their own, while Fireworks may well be merged with Photoshop. What actually transpires remains to be seen.



Macromedia will enhance Adobe's publishing, design and developer portfolio with products such as Flash, Director, ColdFusion, Authorware, and RoboHelp, among others. Post the merger, Macromedia stockholders will receive 0.69 shares of Adobe common stock for every share of Macromedia common stock.

Sandeep Mehrotra, Sales Manager, Adobe India, confirmed that it will be "business as usual" for the two companies, until close of transaction. Any new products in the offing? "The combined company will not be able to create a joint product roadmap until after the transaction is closed," says Mehrotra.

According to the terms, Adobe CEO Bruce Chizen will retain his position

been cited as one of the reasons why Adobe brings out so many upgrades and changes to all its software with such alarming frequency.

The deal underscores Adobe's growing concern that Microsoft is set to encroach on the wide marketshare enjoyed by both Adobe and Macromedia. Adobe's PDF document format is an industry standard for businesses, and its Acrobat Reader software ships with most computers.

Although Adobe brings in most of its revenues from its Photoshop and Illustrator design tools, the company has begun to centre its business around document creation and collaboration using PDF. Macromedia's Flash, meanwhile, is the standard for Web animation and is

**VALIDATION FIRST**

## Microsoft Introduces 'Piracy Lock'

Microsoft users who wish to download local language add-ons to